

UNIT 1

- **Explain** the basic elements and processes involved in human communication using major communication models.
- **Differentiate** between linear, interactive, and transactional models of communication.
- **Apply** communication models to analyse real-life situations such as team meetings, presentations, emails, interviews, and technical discussions.
- **Identify** where and why communication breakdowns occur—for example, due to noise, ambiguity, inappropriate channels, poor feedback, or differences in interpretation.
- **Select appropriate communication strategies** for different professional and technical situations.
- **Evaluate** the effectiveness of communication in collaborative engineering and workplace environments.
- **Demonstrate awareness** that effective communication is a two-way/interactive process involving feedback, context, interpretation, and relationships.



<https://www.youtube.com/shorts/7MZ5SJPtPIo?feature=share>



<https://youtu.be/815NUDirMGY>



<https://youtu.be/lpvGArSoPHs>

An aerial photograph of a city skyline, likely London, featuring prominent skyscrapers such as the Gherkin and the Shard. The image is overlaid with a dark blue text box containing the title. The background shows a dense urban landscape with various buildings and construction cranes under a hazy sky.

What are Communication Models?

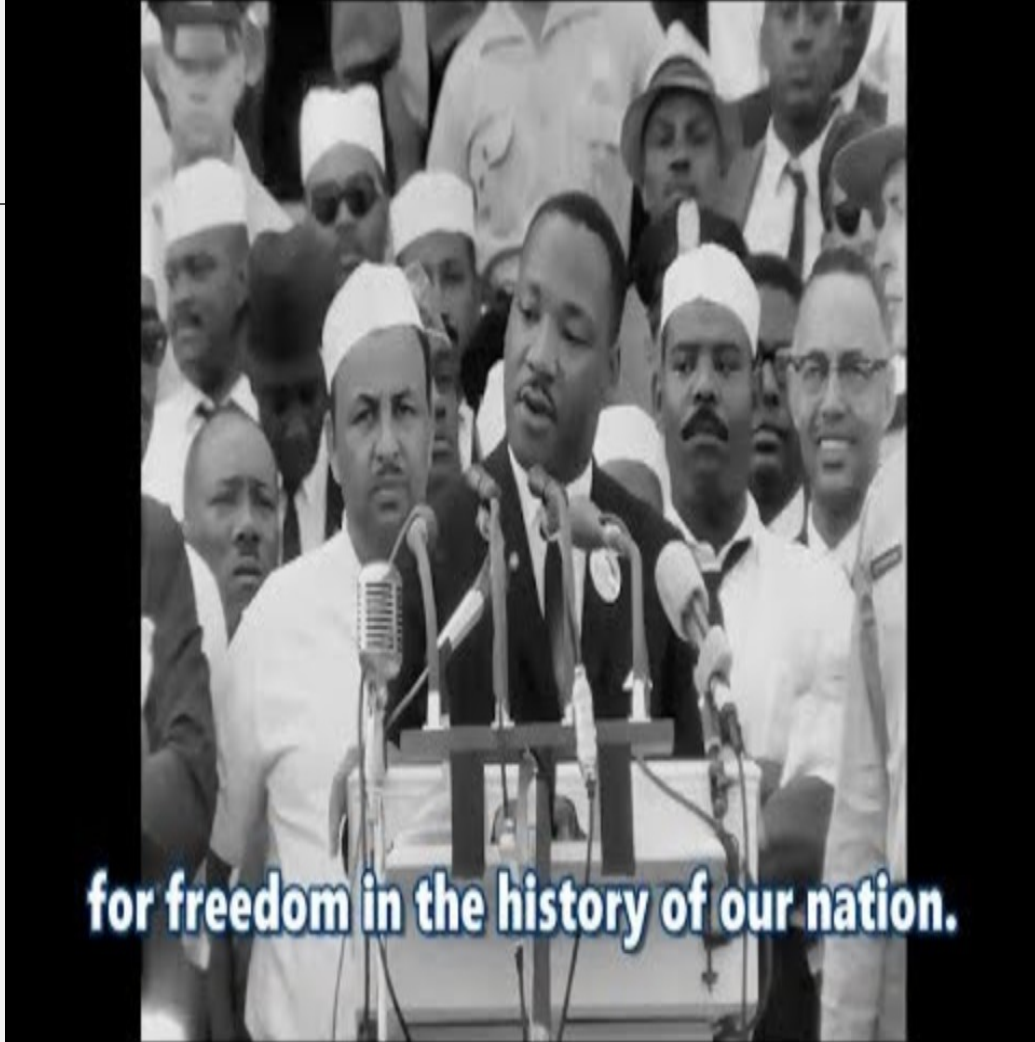
Communication Models

- Whether verbal, non-verbal, written, or visual,
- Communication shapes our interactions, relationships, and society.
- Communication models are simplified representations of the overall process that provide a structured way to analyze and understand, highlighting the roles of different elements and their interactions.

Linear Models

Communication as Transmission

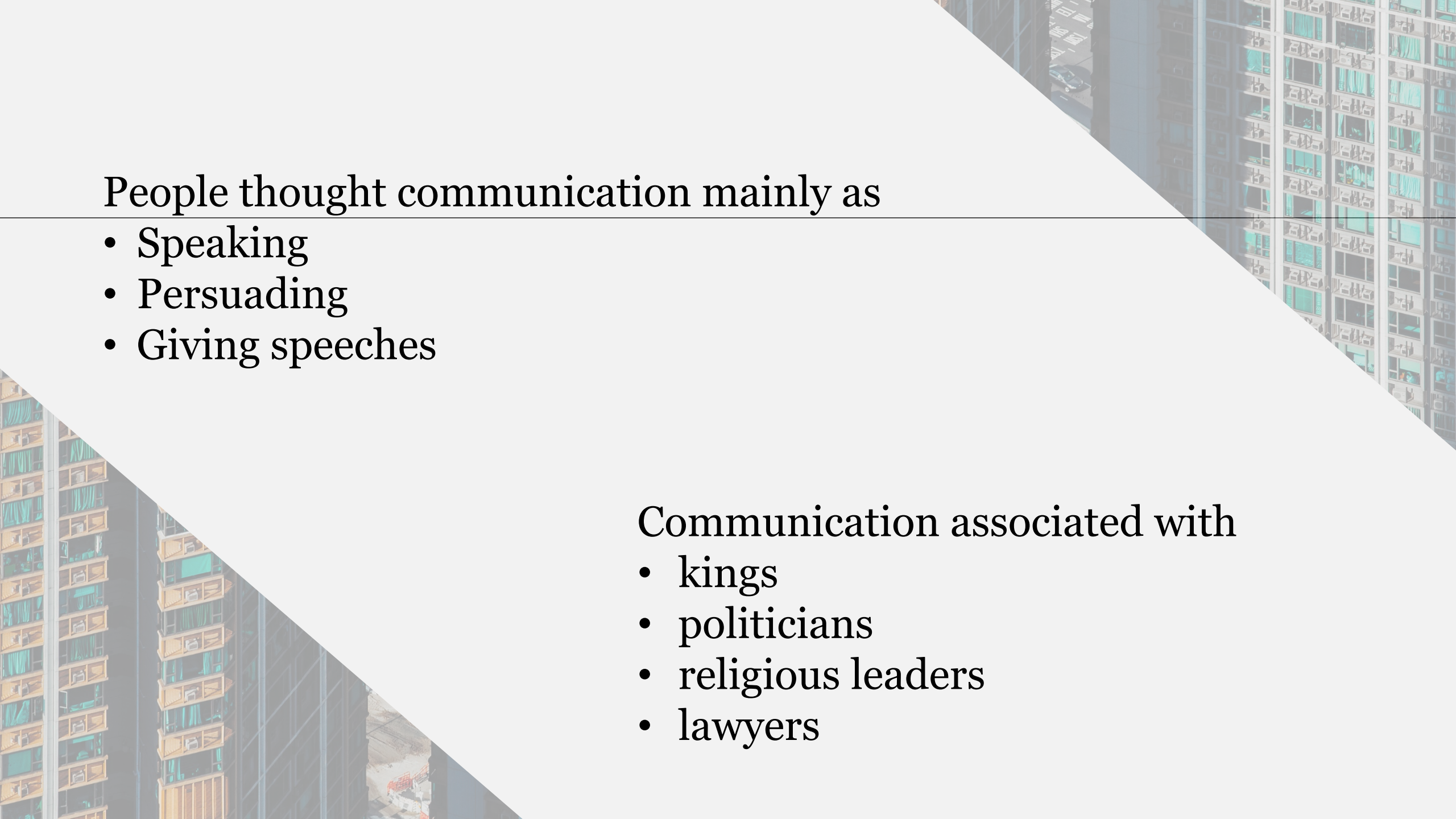




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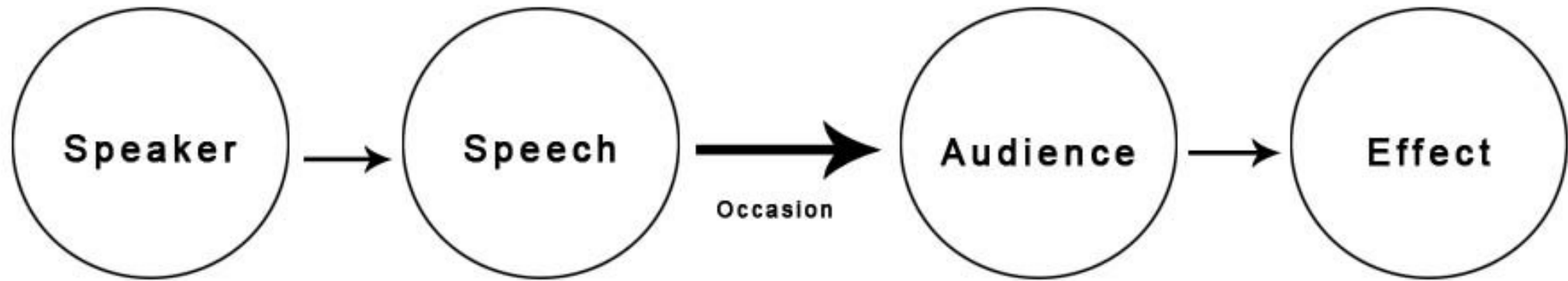
People thought communication mainly as

- Speaking
- Persuading
- Giving speeches

Communication associated with

- kings
- politicians
- religious leaders
- lawyers

Aristotle's Communication Model



Alexander gave a brave speech to his soldiers in the war field to defeat Persian Empire.

Speaker – Alexander

Speech – about his invasion

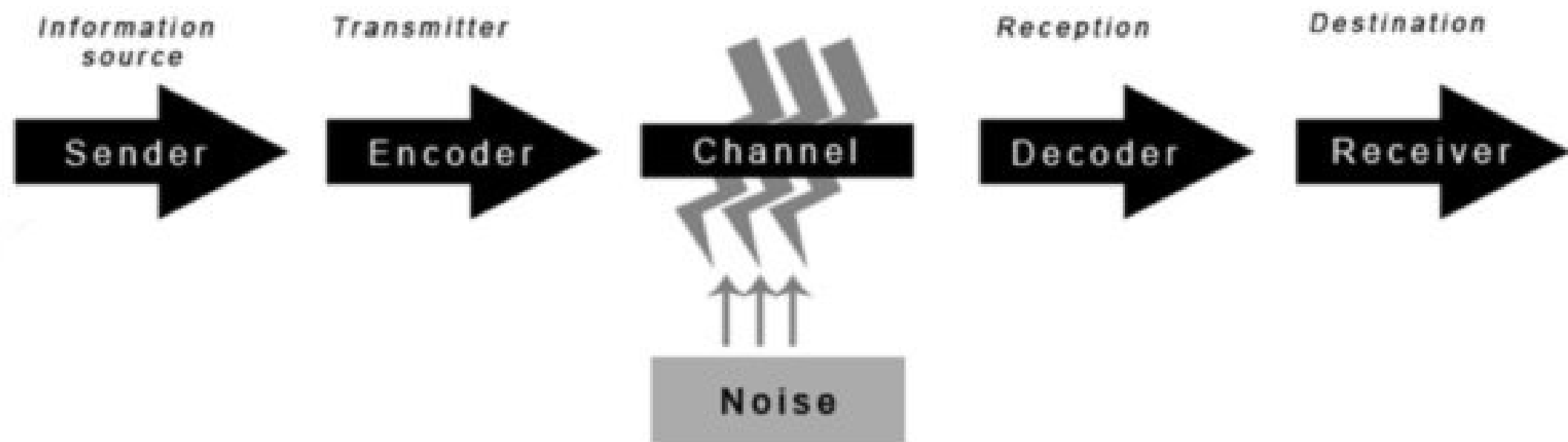
Occasion – War field

Audience – Soldiers

Effect – To defeat Persia



<https://youtu.be/aOmYRmK5irk>



SHANNON-WEAVER'S MODEL OF COMMUNICATION

- Teacher explains chapter

↓ Microphone

↓ Speaker system

↓ Students hear

- Noise

Fan

Mobile

poor internet

bad handwriting

Accent

The message becomes distorted.

- “ If I speak, you understand.”

Shannon said No.

Messages can be destroyed.

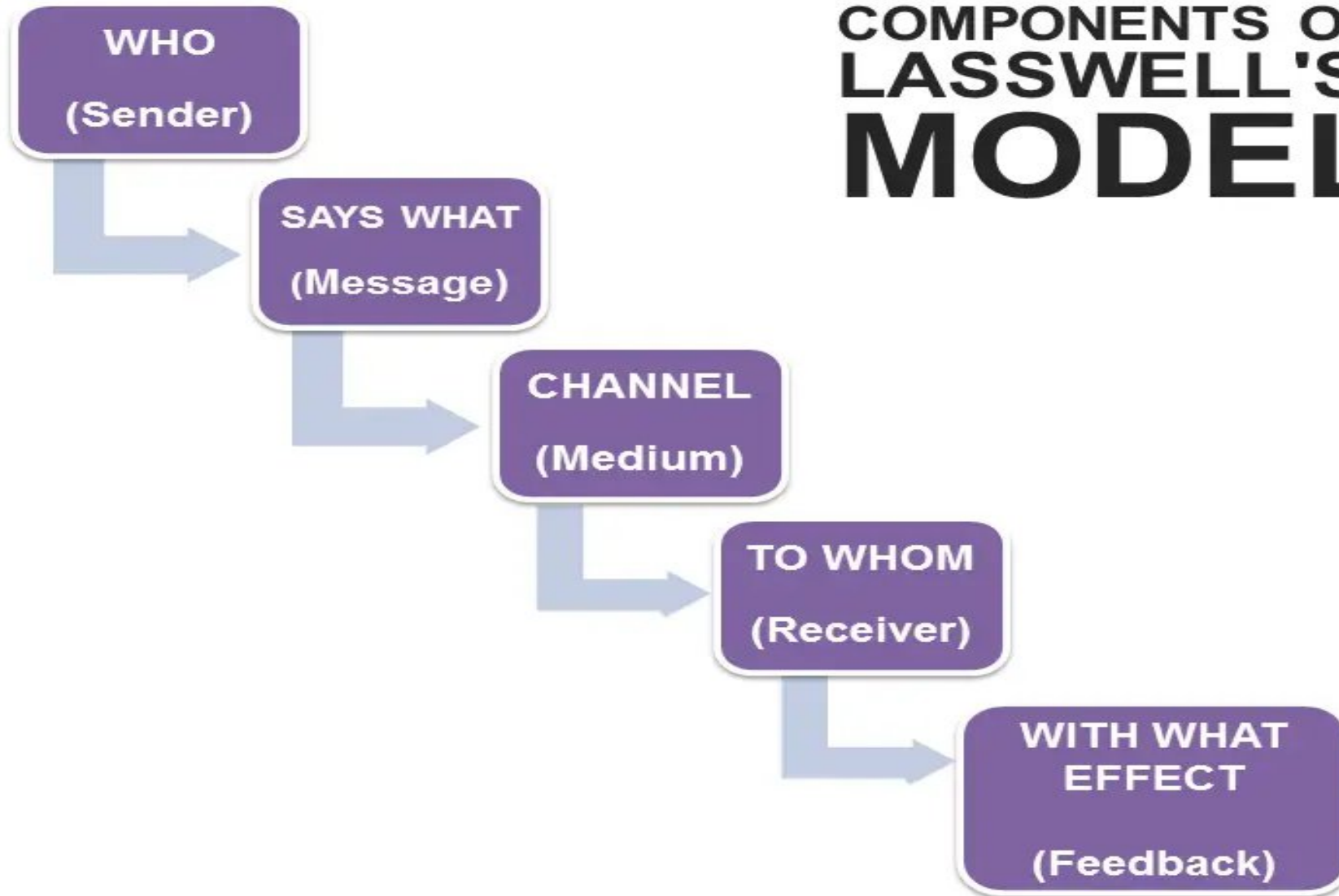
- Noise became one of the greatest concepts in communication.

Different kinds of Noise

- | | | | |
|----------------|-----------------|---|-----------------|
| • Physical | • Psychological | • Semantic | • Physiological |
| • Construction | • Stress | • Different meanings | • Poor hearing |
| • Fan | • Anxiety | • Teacher says "This assignment is optional." | • Headache |
| • Traffic | • Anger | • Students hear "It isn't important." | • Fatigue |



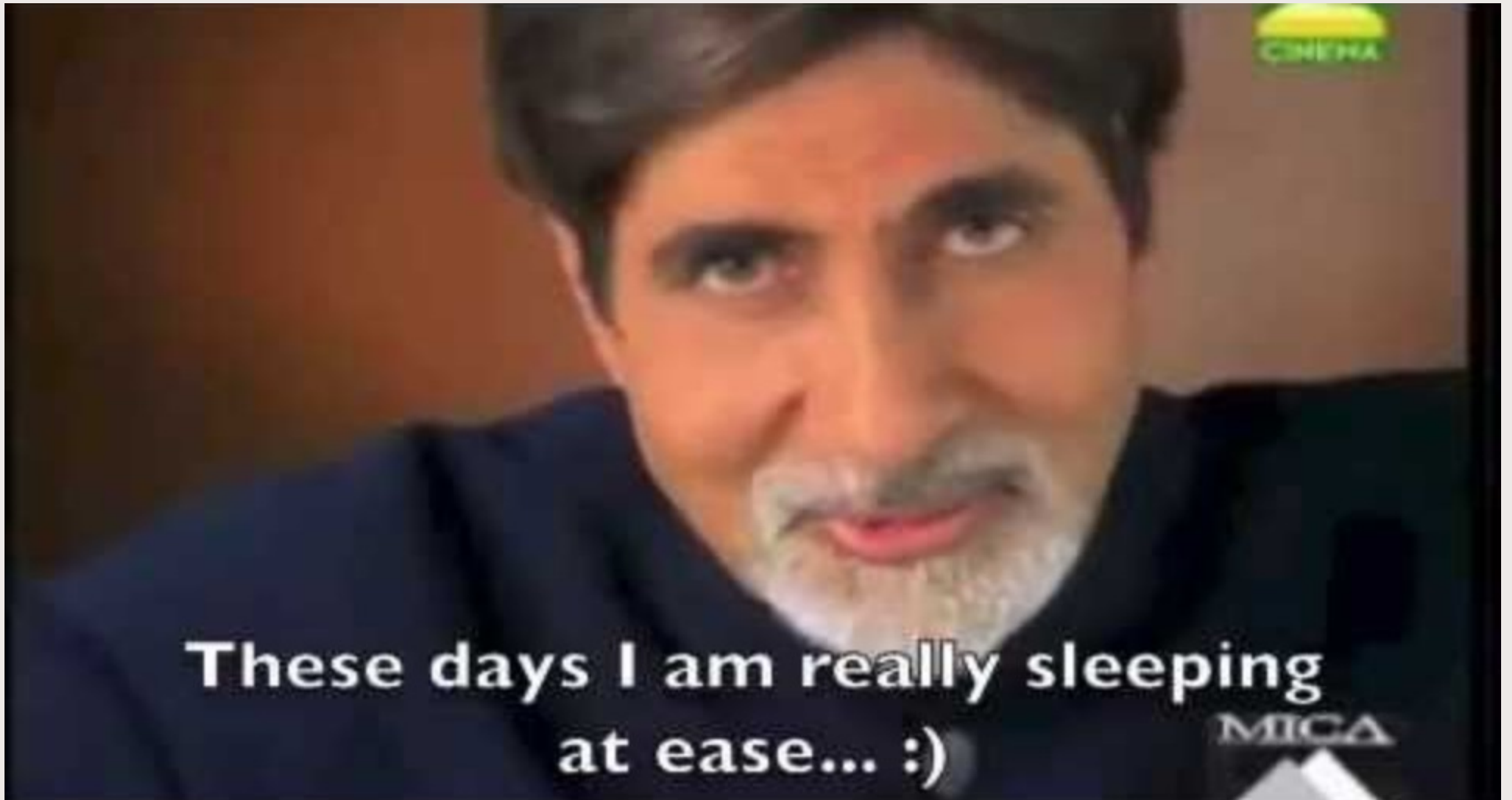
COMPONENTS OF LASSWELL'S MODEL



- **Control analysis** helps the sender to have all the power.
- **Content analysis** is associated to stereotyping and representation of different groups politically. It is also related to the purpose or the ulterior motives of the message.
- **Media analysis** represents which medium should be used to exercise maximum power against the receivers.
- **Audience analysis** shows who are the target population to be manipulated.
- **Effect analysis** is done before the process starts. It is used to predict the effect of message over the target population to be exploited.



<https://youtu.be/s3V5zMuoDac>



**These days I am really sleeping
at ease... :)**

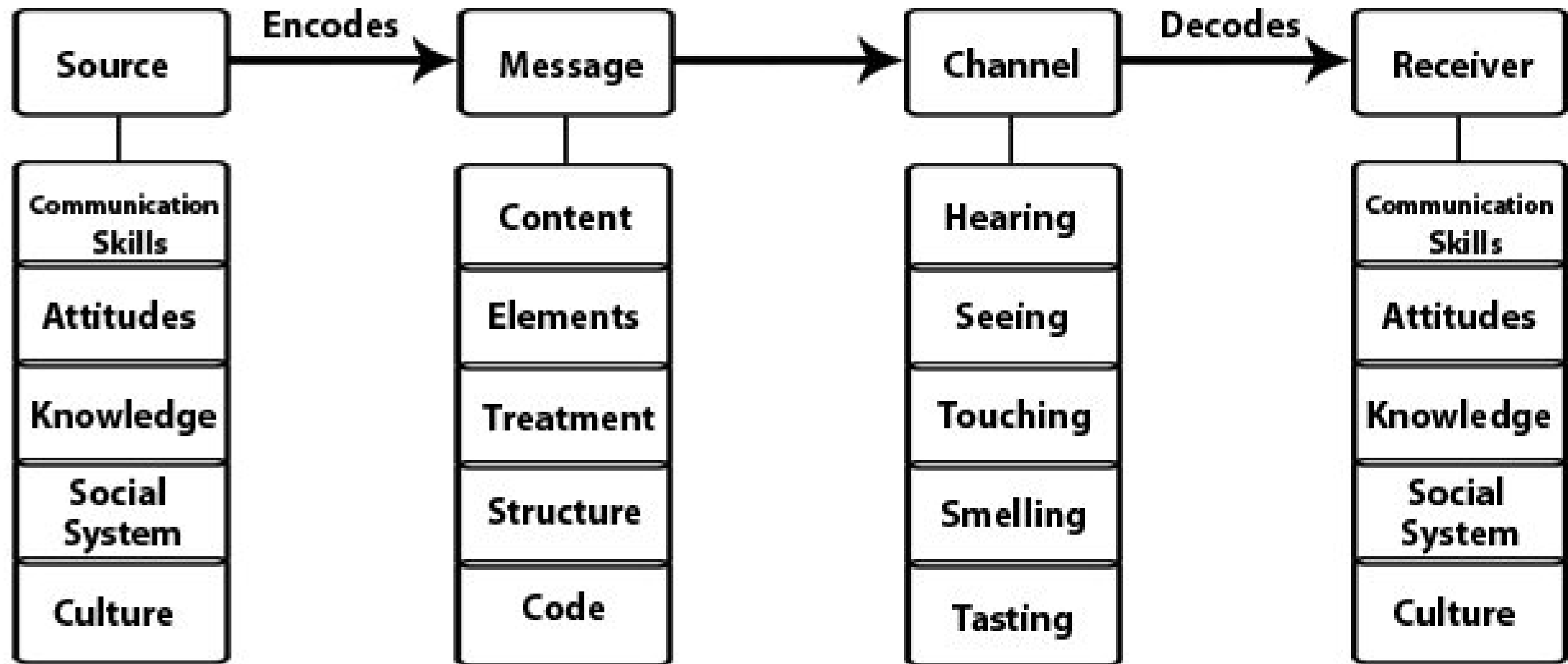
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Lasswell element	Before the crisis	After the crisis
Who	Cadbury (faceless corporate voice)	Cadbury <i>through</i> Amitabh Bachchan
Says what	"Kuch meetha ho jaaye" (enjoy)	"We saw the problem, we fixed it, here's proof"
Channel	TV ads only	TV + press conferences + trade videos + retailer kits
To whom	General consumers	Consumers + media + retailers + own sales force, separately
With what effect	Routine purchase	Trust collapse → measured, gradual trust recovery

The Jaipur Flyover Accident. The Event (Reality) at 8:30 a.m., a motorcycle skids on an oil spill near a flyover in Jaipur. The rider suffers minor injuries. A nearby shopkeeper immediately helps him, and an ambulance arrives within ten minutes. This is the actual event (E).

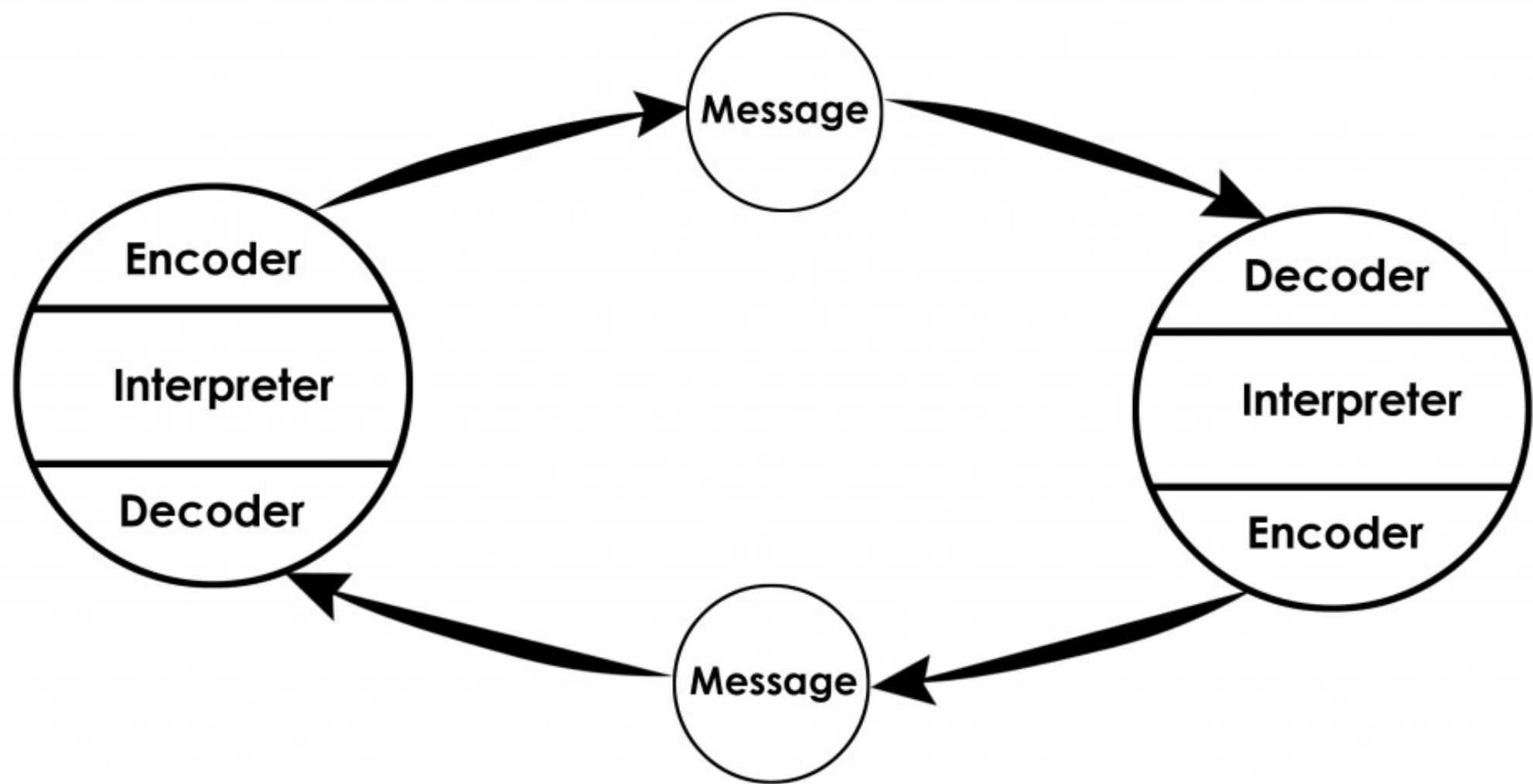
Event (Reality)	Motorcycle accident
Perception	Each observer notices different details
Interpretation	Engineering problem, speeding, governance failure, emotional crisis
Representation	News article, police report, Instagram reel, phone call
Receiver	Public interprets each version differently

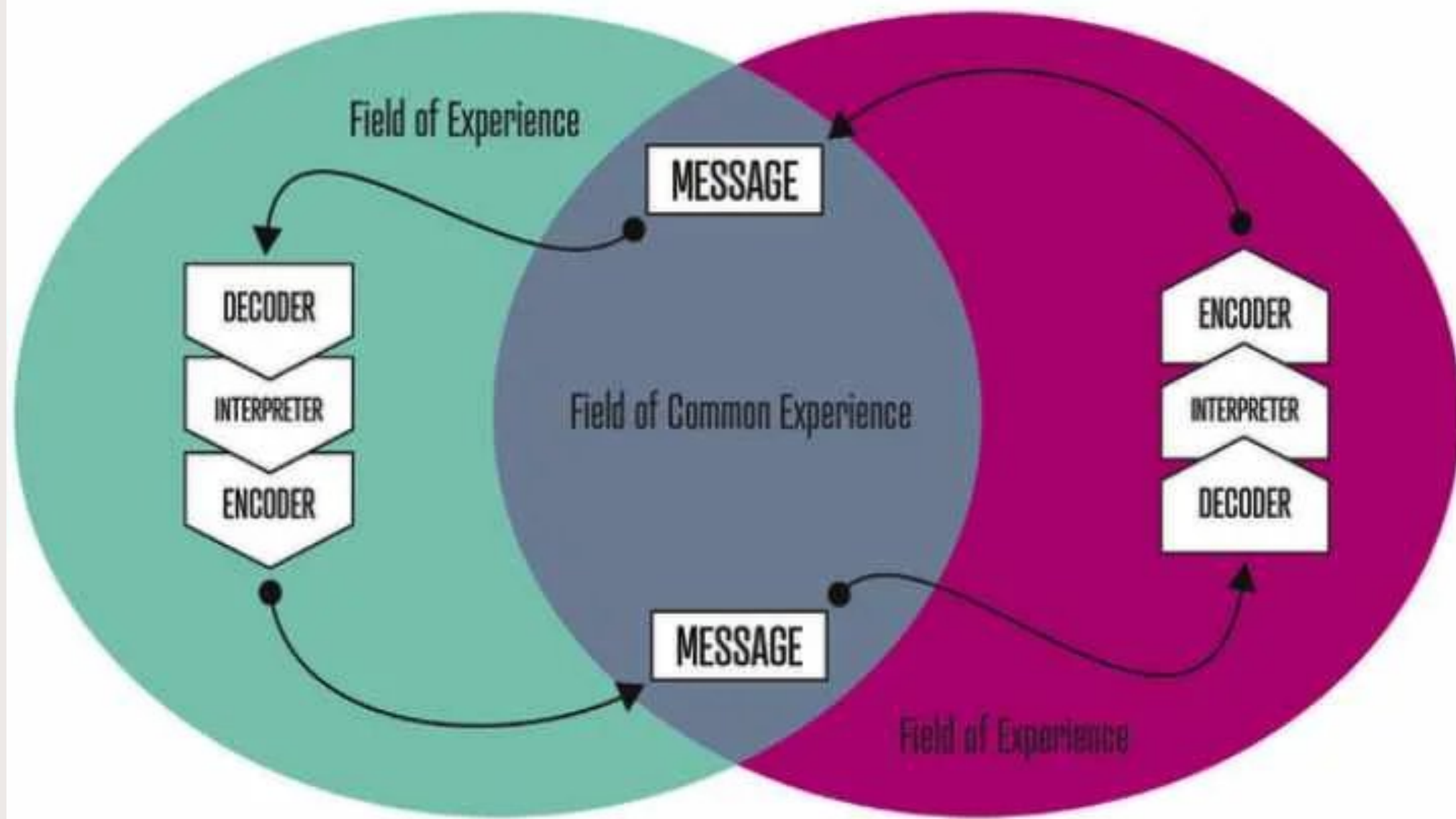
Berlos's SMCR Model of communication

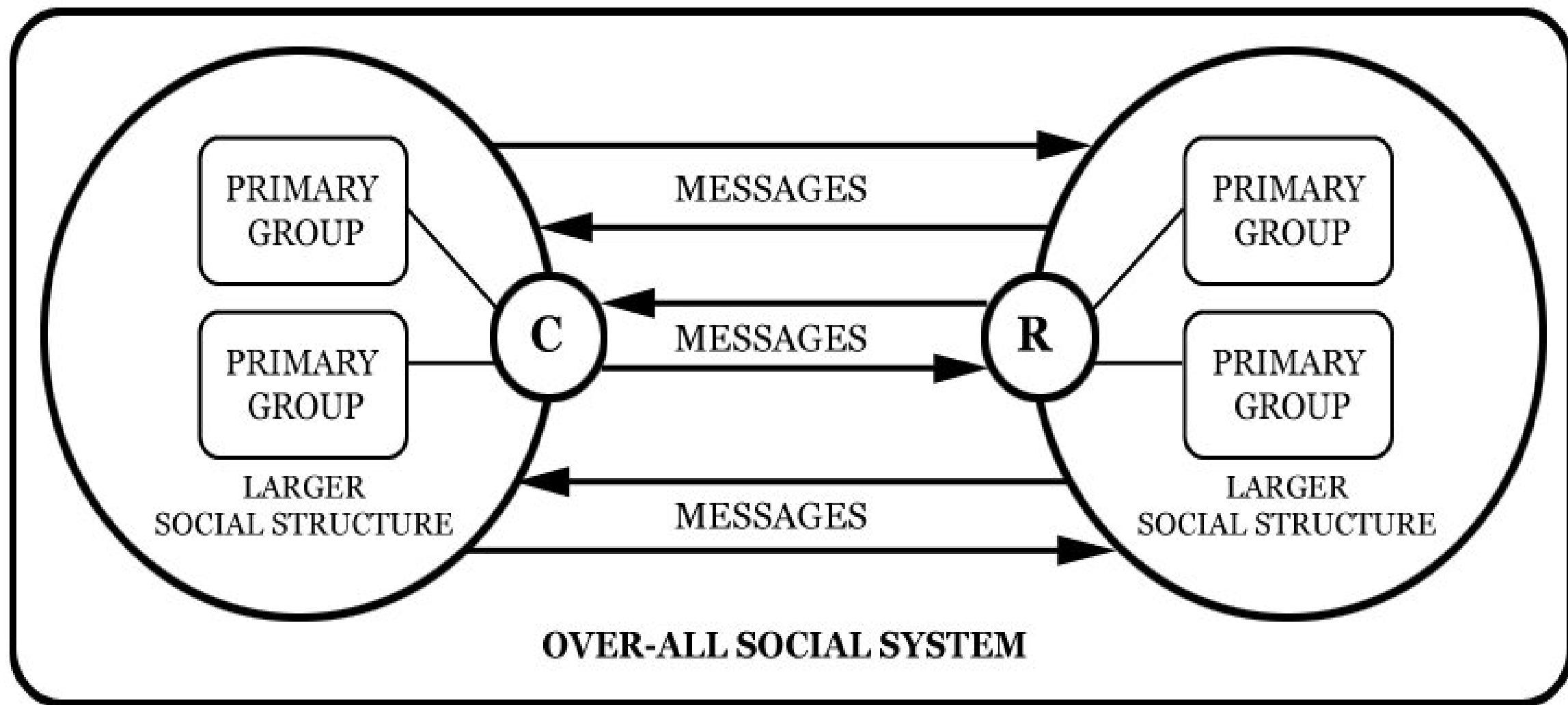


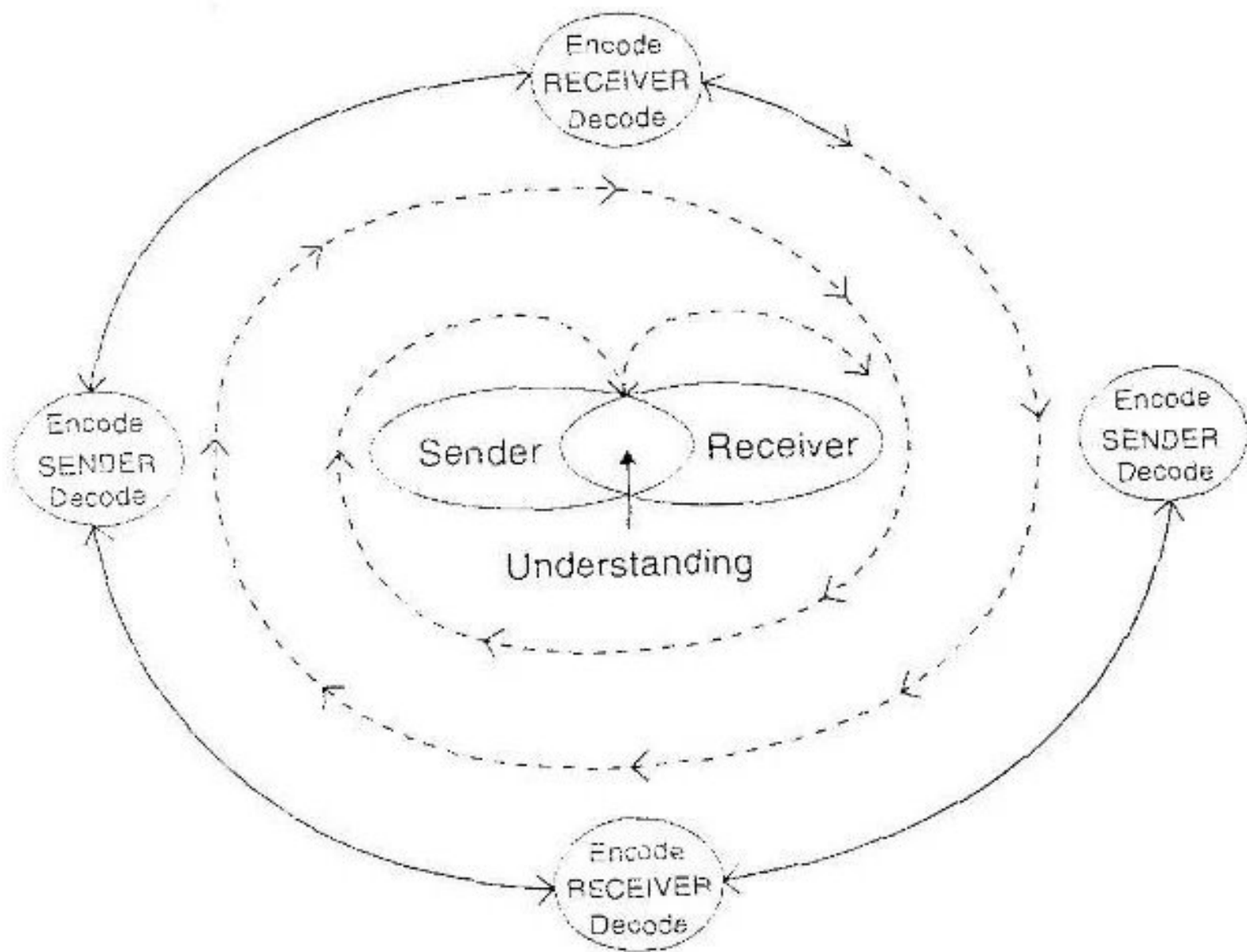
Interactive Models

Communication became a dialogue.









Transactional Models

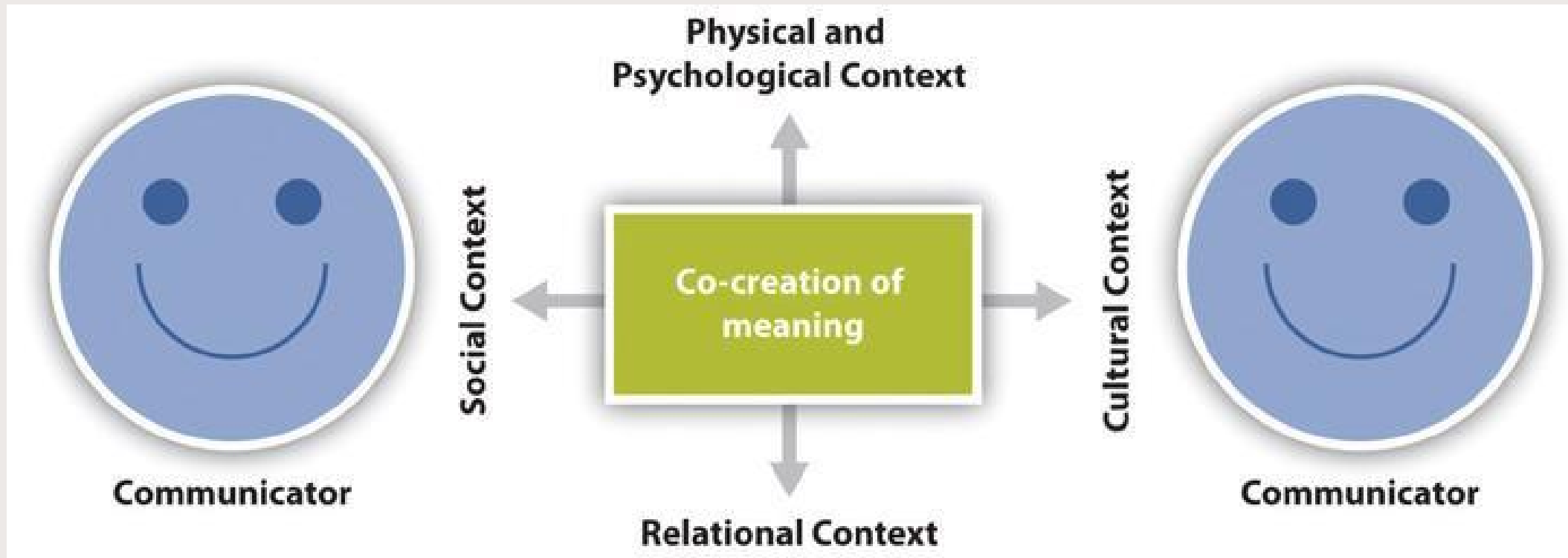
Communication is not Turn-taking.

It happens simultaneously.

- communication is a continuous process where everyone is simultaneously sending and receiving messages.

While speaking,

- you are also watching facial expressions
- Listening
- Adjusting words
- Changing tone
- Thinking
- Interpreting silence
- Everything happens together.



Transactional Model of Communication Image by Andy Schmitz is licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 3.0

Communication as a continuous process

- Communication is “not a static event or a singular act”, but a continuous, evolving process. This dynamic exchange unfolds over time, meaning that communication happens through ongoing interactions rather than once-and-done transmissions.
- Communication is an active, constantly changing “back-and-forth exchange”.
- It is ****unfolding and fluid****, never fixed or fully completed at any given moment

Communication is Circular, Not Linear

- Both parties are “simultaneously senders and receivers”, engaging in reciprocal influence.
- Even “nonverbal cues” play a role in this continuous feedback loop.
- Communication is best understood as a “circular, interactive process” rather than a one-way flow.

Communication is Complex: The Six “People” Involved

1. Self-identity - Who you think you are in that moment.
 2. Other's identity - Who you think the other person is during the communication.
 3. Perceived judgment - Who you think the other thinks you are.
 4. Other's self-identity - Who the other person thinks they are.
 5. You as perceived by other - Who the other person thinks you are
 6. The other's perception of your perception - Who the other thinks you think they are.
- This model shows the multi-layered cognitive processes behind even simple greetings.
 - It explains why communication is highly nuanced and mentally demanding.

Communication is Irreversible

- The idea of “disregarding” or “deleting from the record” is often unrealistic.
- Words leave a “lasting impact, stored in memory and relational context”.
- This principle warns of the “permanence and responsibility” inherent in communication.

Communication Involves the Total Personality of the Sender

- Communication is 'not merely individual behaviours or words', but reflects the entire person.
- How one speaks shapes and is shaped by 'self-concept and perceptions of others'.
- Understanding this helps realize that communication is deeply 'personal and identity-driven'.

Communication Is	Key	
Persuasion	Speaker–Speech–Audience	speeches
Transmission	Noise	No feedback
Media effects	Five questions	Passive audience
Dialogue	Feedback, Field of Experience	Turn-taking
Mutual exchange	Both encode/decode	Limited treatment of context
Shared meaning	Simultaneous communication, context	More complex to represent

The important features of the transactional model of communication are

A) Feedback is repetitive.

B) It is mostly used for inter-personal communication.

C) The senders and the receivers of messages can inter-change their roles.

D) Feedback is simultaneous.

E) The heavy dose of noise provides a message.

Choose the correct answer from the options given below:

1. A, B, and C only

2. B, C, and D only

3. C, D, and E only

4. A, D, and E only



<https://youtu.be/gHGDN9-oFJE>

Definitions

The origin of the word “communication” is “communicare” or “communis” which means “to impart”, “to participate”, “to share” or “to make common.” The sense of sharing is inherent in the very origin and meaning of “communication.”

1. Keith Davis: Communication is a process of passing information and understanding from one person to another.
2. John Adair: Communication is essentially the ability of one person to make contact with another and make himself or herself understood.
3. William Newman and Charles Summer: Communication is an exchange of ideas, facts, opinions or emotions of two or more persons.
4. Louis Allen: Communication is a bridge of meaning. It involves a systematic and continuous process of telling, listening and understanding.
5. Peter Little: Communication is a process by which information is transmitted between individuals and / or organizations so that an understanding response results.
6. Murphy, Hildebrandt, Thomas: Communication is a process of transmitting and receiving verbal and non-verbal messages. It is considered effective when it achieves the desired response or reaction from the receiver.

Formal and Informal Communication

- Distinguish between formal and informal communication.
- Identify how **context, purpose, relationship, audience and medium** affect communication style.
- Differentiate **formal, semi-formal and colloquial language**.
- Adapt the same message for different professional and social situations.
- Recognize inappropriate informality and unnecessary formality.
- Rewrite colloquial messages into appropriate professional language.

“Hey sir, I can't come tomorrow coz I'm not feeling well. also, mark my attendance.”

“Good evening, Sir. I am unwell and will not be able to attend tomorrow's class. I request you to kindly grant me leave for the day.”

Translate

"I need your report by tomorrow."

How would you say this to:

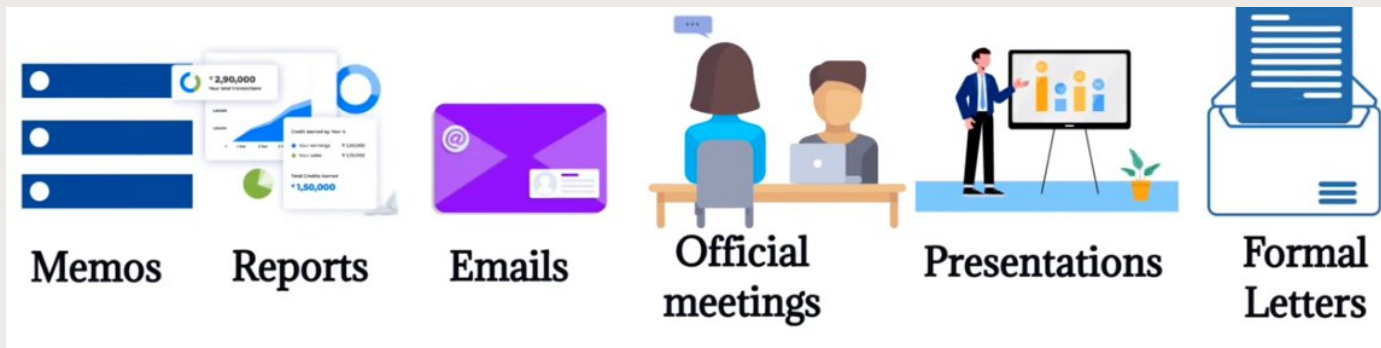
1. Your best friend
2. Your professor
3. Your CEO

Communication = Message + Context + Audience + Purpose +
Relationship + Medium

Formal communication

Communication that follows the **expected conventions, roles, structures and language norms** of a particular institution or professional context.

Informal communication occurs in situations where communication is less governed by institutional rules and more influenced by familiarity, relationships and everyday interaction.



C — Context

Where and under what circumstances are you communicating?

P — Purpose

Why are you communicating?

A — Audience

Who are you communicating with?

R — Relationship

What is your relationship with the person?

Then add:

M — Medium

Email? WhatsApp? Phone? Face-to-face? Official letter?

CPARM = Context + Purpose + Audience + Relationship + Medium

Informal Communication...

Is less rigidly structured

Has a more relaxed tone

Uses more casual language

Places less emphasis on correct grammar and spelling

Is used mainly with peers and other people you know well

Is more likely to be needed in personal situations

Formal Communication...

Is more rigidly structured

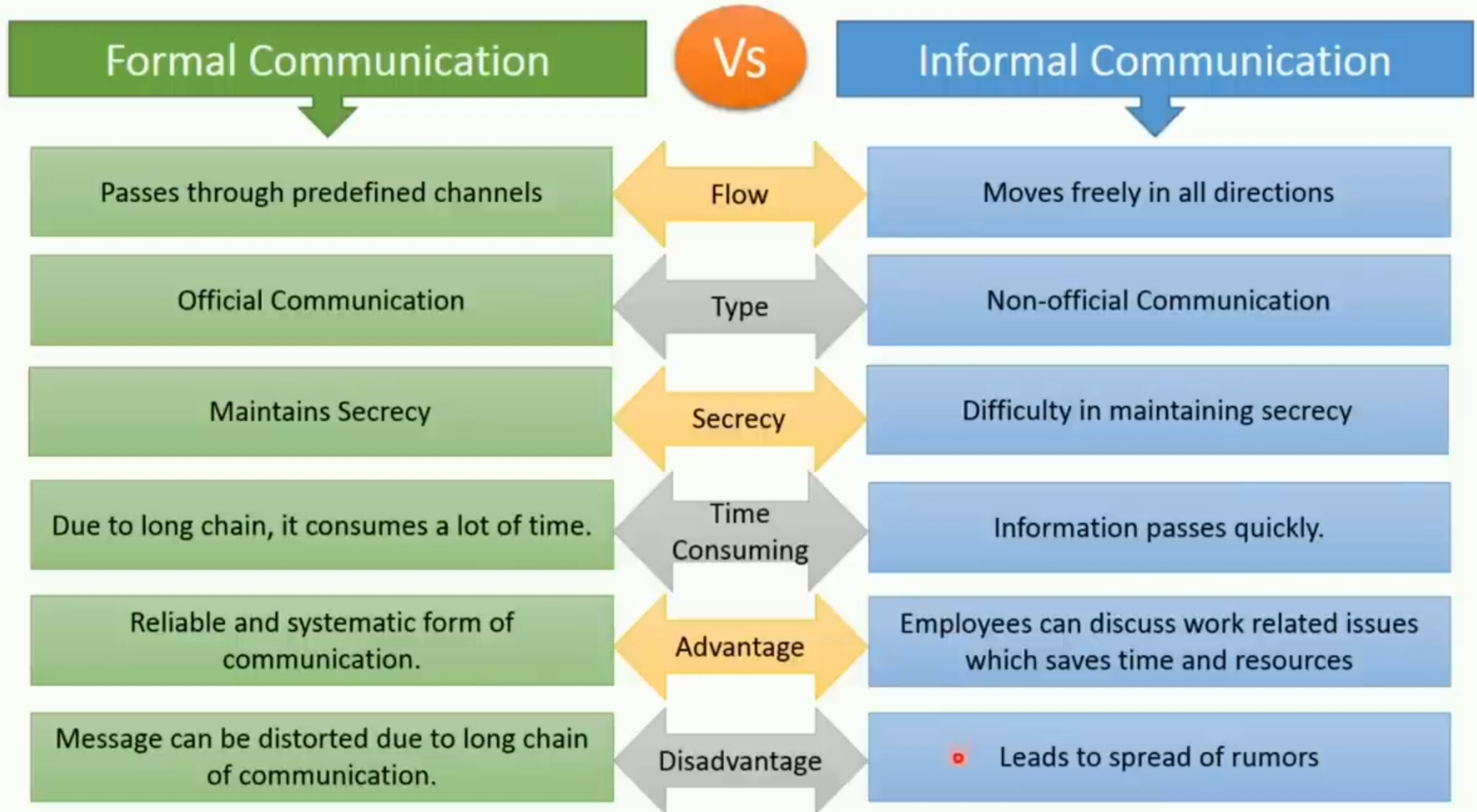
Has a more formal tone

Uses more standard language

Places higher importance on correct grammar and spelling

Is used mainly with non-peers & people you don't know well

Is more likely to be needed in business, career, or educational situations



Colloquial

gonna

wanna

gotta

stuff

a lot of

kids

boss

put off

deal with

find out

help out

hang on

formal/professional

going to

want to

have to

materials/items/information

many/much/significant

children

manager/supervisor

postpone

address

determine/find

assist

wait

Formal

I am unable to attend.

I would like to request...

Please inform me.

I apologise.

Thank you for your
assistance.

I do not understand.

I will contact you shortly.

I would appreciate it if...

Could you please...?

I am writing to inform you...

Informal/

I can't make it.

Can you...

Let me know.

Sorry!

Thanks for helping.

I don't get it.

I'll get back to you.

I'd really appreciate it.

Can you...?

Just wanted to tell you...

FORMAL

Acceptable

Riding a bicycle to work is acceptable.

Regarding / concerning

I'm writing this email concerning our project.

Assistance

I appreciate your assistance.

Commence

Our meeting will commence shortly.

Sufficient

We have sufficient data.

INFORMAL

Okay

Riding a bicycle to work is okay.

About

I'm writing this email about our project.

Help

I appreciate your help.

Start

Our meeting will start shortly.

Enough

We have enough data.

FORMAL

You compelled me to commit this course of action.

We regret to inform you that your application was rejected due to insufficient requirements.

In conclusion, it can be argued that the consequence of smoking may be detrimental and may lead to deterioration of our health.

INFORMAL

You made me do this thing.

Sorry but your application was turned down because of lack of requirements.

So, we can say that the effect of smoking can take its toll on our health.

FORMAL

Our computers were repaired
by the technician.

The ceremony will be held
in a hall.

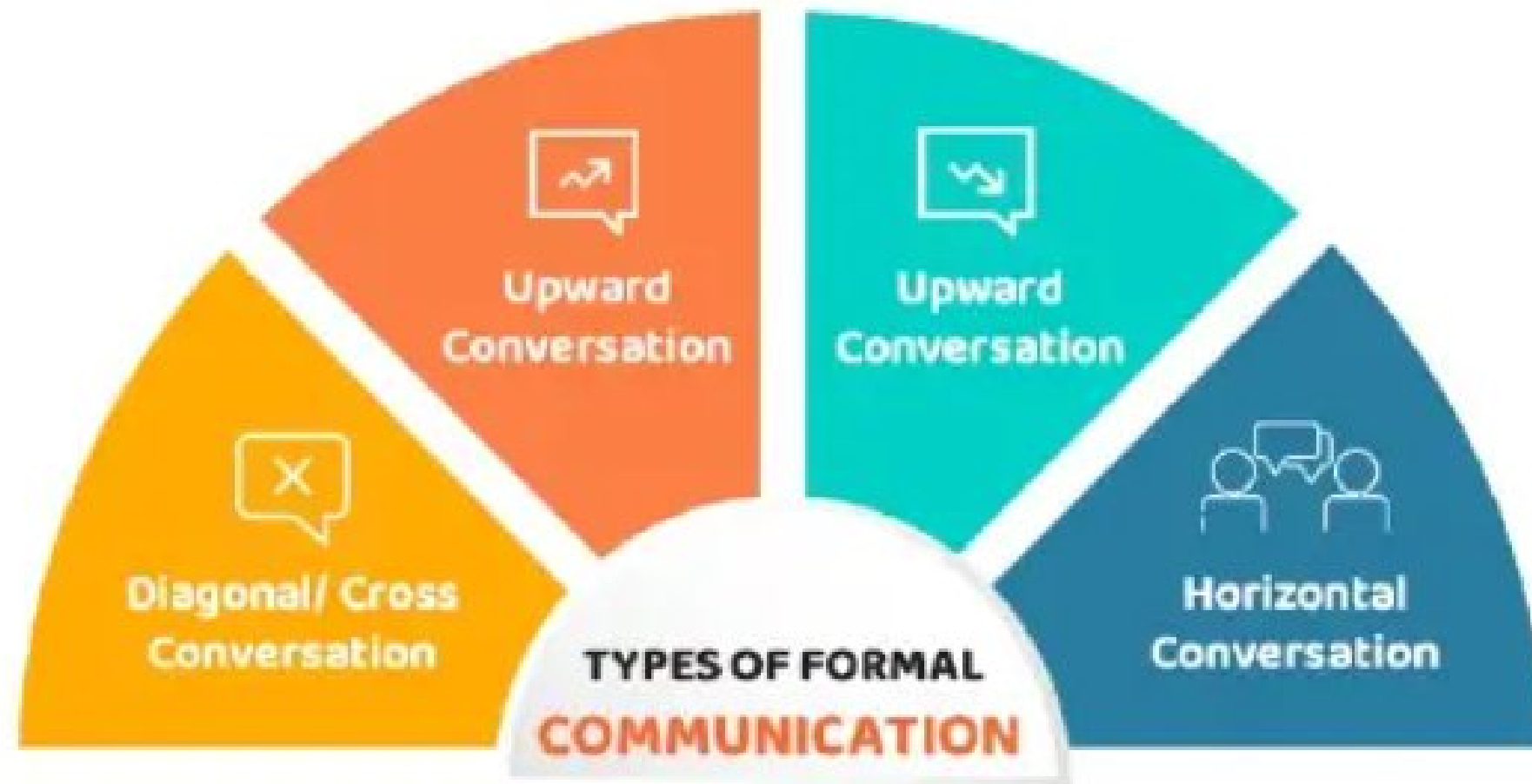
The products are checked
from time to time.

INFORMAL

The technician repaired
our computers.

We will hold the ceremony
in a hall.

I check the products from
time to time.



GRAPEVINE - INFORMAL COMMUNICATION



Faster information flow	Spread of rumours and misinformation
Quick feedback	Potential for exclusion
Improved relationships	Lack of documentation
Enhanced collaboration	Distraction and wasted time
Increased employee engagement	Difficulty in control

One standard English?

Standard English is the form of English that follows the **accepted rules of grammar, vocabulary, spelling, and sentence structure** used in a particular English-speaking community.

I don't have any information about the meeting.

I ain't got no information about the meeting.

Hey sir,
I can't come to class tomorrow coz I've got some work. Can u pls tell me what I missed?
Thx.

Dear Sir,
I will be unable to attend tomorrow's class due to a personal commitment. Could you please let me know if there are any important announcements or materials that I should review?
Thank you.

Bro, send me the PPT asap. I need it for tomorrow.

Could you please share the presentation at your earliest convenience? I need it for tomorrow's submission.

Good communication is not the most formal communication. It is the most appropriate communication.

1. Do you even think before speaking ?

Let's make sure we align our thoughts internally before saying it out loud.

2. -----

I would like see more tangible deliverables alongside the discussions.

3. -----

The report needs a quality pass – there are gaps that need to addressed before it goes out.

4. -----

This approach could put the team's overall success at risk – lets course correct.

5. -----

I would like to reiterate the suggestions that I have provided

“My brother is coming to collect my documents because I can't come to college myself. Please give them to him.

To

The *Concerned Authority*

[University/College Name]

[Department Name]

Subject: Authorization to Collect My Documents

Respected Sir/Madam,

I, [Your Full Name], a student of [Course/Program], [Year/Semester], hereby authorize my brother, **[Brother's Full Name]**, to collect my documents from the university on my behalf.

As I am unable to visit the university personally, I kindly request you to hand over the required documents to him. He will provide the necessary identification and authorization, if required.

I would be grateful for your kind cooperation and assistance.

Thank you.

Yours sincerely,

[Your Full Name]

[Enrollment/Roll Number]

[Course/Program]

[Contact Number]

Subject: Authorization Letter for Collection of Documents

Respected Sir/Madam,

I, **[Your Full Name]**, a student of **[Course/Program]**, [Year/Semester], with Enrollment/Roll Number **[Enrollment/Roll Number]**, am unable to visit the university personally to collect my documents.

Therefore, I would like to authorize my brother, **[Brother's Full Name]**, to collect the documents on my behalf. I kindly request you to **could you please hand over the required documents to him** upon verification of his identity and the necessary authorization.

I would sincerely appreciate your kind cooperation and assistance in this regard.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

[Your Full Name]

[Enrollment/Roll Number]

[Course/Program]

[Contact Number]

Date: [Date]

Barriers to effective communication

- Identify common barriers to communication.
- Distinguish between **language, psychological, physiological, attitudinal and systematic barriers.**
- Recognise how barriers distort a message.
- Suggest an appropriate strategy to overcome a barrier.
- Understand that **communication failure is not always the sender's fault**

“The plenary session for the placement orientation scheduled for Friday has been moved to Monday at 10 a.m. Students must bring their resumes and arrive 15 minutes early.”

Send me the report soon.

- Student 1: **You are in a hurry.**
- Student 2: **You don't think the orientation is important.**
- Student 3: **You are unsure what “plenary” means.**
- Student 4: **You remember only numbers.**
- Student 5: **You assume it is Friday.**
- Student 6: **You are distracted by your phone.**

- Communication is not simply sending a message. Your material defines effective communication as exchanging ideas, thoughts, knowledge and information so that the intended purpose is fulfilled.
- A communication barrier is anything that distorts, blocks or interrupts a message

Instead of:

Sender → Message → Receiver

we get:

Sender →  → Message →  → Receiver

- 1. LANGUAGE** - Words / jargon / ambiguity
- 2. PSYCHOLOGICAL** - Stress / anger / fear / anxiety
- 3. PHYSIOLOGICAL** - Physical condition affecting reception
- 4. ATTITUDINAL** - Attitude / prejudice / resistance
- 5. SYSTEMATIC** - Problems in organisational structures/channels

Professor: "Your argument lacks epistemological coherence."

Student: 😊

Better: "Your argument needs a clearer explanation of how you know what you claim to know."

Common causes

- Unfamiliar vocabulary
- Jargon
- Abbreviations
- Ambiguous words
- Different languages
- Accents

PSYCHOLOGICAL BARRIER

Your mind becomes the barrier.

Stress



Anxiety



Anger



Fear



Low self-esteem



Poor communication

Example

Teacher: "Can we talk about your assignment?"

Student is already anxious:
"I'm in trouble."

But the teacher may simply want to discuss the assignment.

We don't always hear what is said. Sometimes we hear what our emotional state allows us to hear.

Physiological Barrier

The receiver's **physical condition** affects communication.

Examples:

- Hearing difficulty
- Speech difficulty
- Fatigue
- Physical discomfort
- Other physical conditions affecting reception

Attitudinal Barrier

Sometimes the problem isn't: **"I don't understand you."**

It is: **"I don't WANT to understand you."**

Examples

- Prejudice
- Resistance to change
- Lack of motivation
- Personality conflict
- Distrust
- "I already know everything."

SYSTEMATIC BARRIER

The problem is **the system**, not necessarily the individual.

Example

Student has a problem.

Student → Class Representative → Coordinator → Faculty → HOD →
Administration

By the time the message reaches the final person:

"I have a problem with my attendance."

becomes:

"Some students are unhappy about attendance."

Barrier detective

1. Please submit the document after applying APA 7th edition formatting.
2. You receive a message - "We need to discuss your performance".
3. An urgent notice passes through four departments before reaching students.

By then, the deadline has changed.

Incorrect Filtering

Original message



Person A



Person B



Person C



Receiver

Every additional person can potentially:

omit + alter + interpret + distort

Poor Listening

Hearing ≠ Listening

HEARING

Sound reaches your ears.

LISTENING

You:

hear → understand → interpret → respond

A technological barrier occurs when technology prevents or complicates effective communication rather than enabling it.

Digital literacy

Teacher:

"Submit your assignment through the LMS."

Student:

"How?"

The technology exists, but the person doesn't know how to use it.

Cultural Barriers

- The Indian student says: "We'll try to finish it by Friday."
- The German student understands this as:
"The deadline is Friday."
- But the Indian student intended:
"We will make an effort, but Friday is not necessarily a firm commitment."

Neither person is necessarily being dishonest or careless.

The norms of social interaction vary greatly in different cultures, as do the way in which emotions are expressed. **For example**, the concept of personal space varies between cultures and between different social settings.

A student refuses to shake hands with someone of the opposite gender because of a religious or cultural practice.

The other person assumes: “They don't respect me.”

But the actual reason is a religious/cultural norm, not disrespect.

A foreign professor enters a classroom and asks everyone to eat together during a religious fasting period. Some students decline. The professor thinks they are being uncooperative.

Ask:

“Is the problem language? No. Is the message unclear? No. Then why has communication failed?”

"Your performance is not good. You need to improve immediately."

"Your presentation has strong ideas, but the structure and delivery need improvement. Let's work on these two areas before your next presentation."

Barrier	What causes it?	Main focus	Example
Cultural	Differences in customs, norms, communication styles, values	How a group communicates	In one culture, direct eye contact shows confidence; in another, prolonged eye contact may be considered disrespectful.
Socio-religious	Religious beliefs, traditions, social norms, practices	What people believe/practice	A person declines certain food because of religious restrictions, but others interpret the refusal as being unfriendly.
Perceptual	Individual experiences, assumptions, attitudes, expectations	How an individual interprets a message	A teacher says, "You can do better." One student hears encouragement; another hears criticism.

Effective communication is a process of exchanging ideas, thoughts, knowledge and information such that the purpose or intention is fulfilled in the best possible manner. In simple words, it is nothing but the presentation of views by the sender in a way best understood by the receiver.

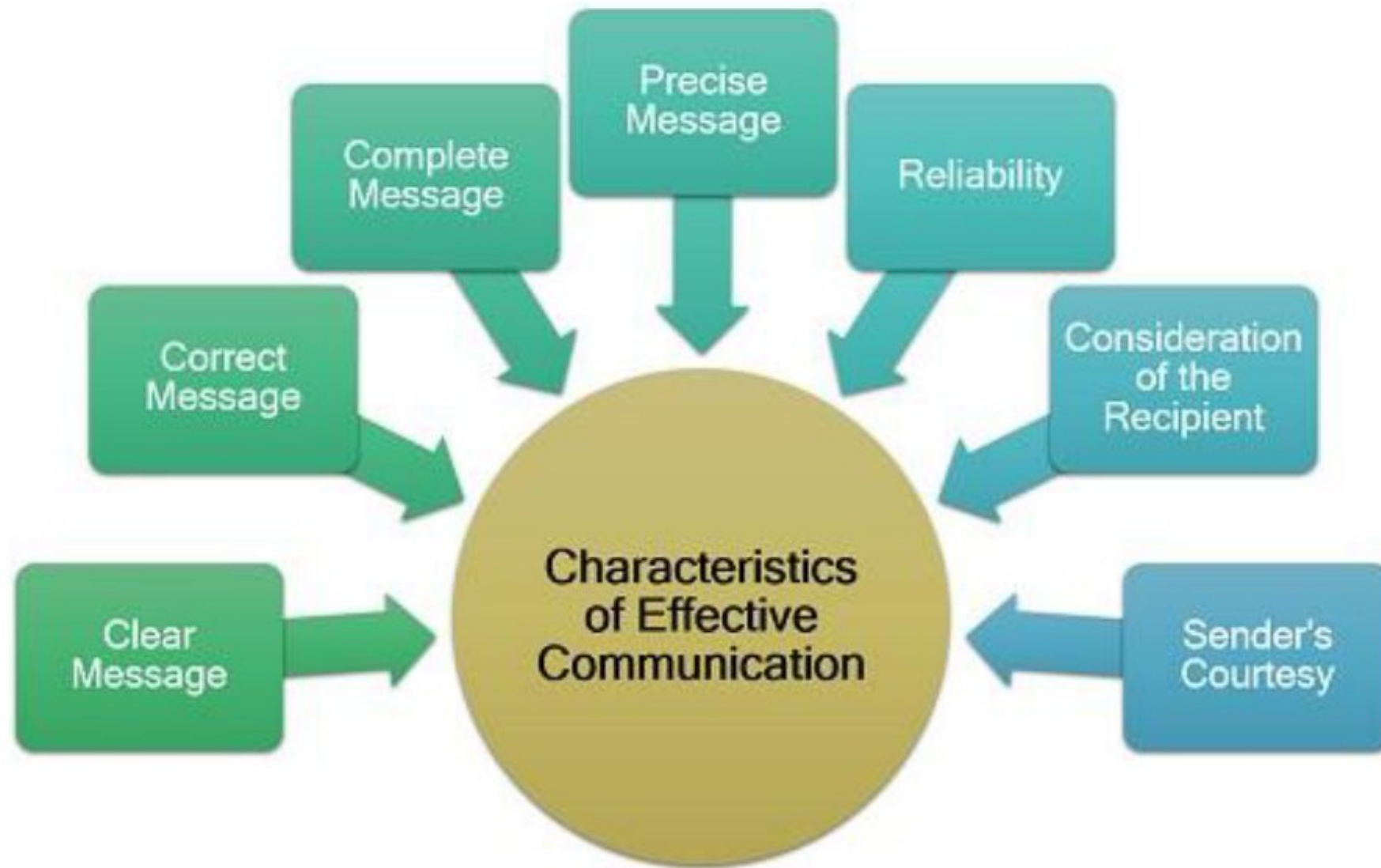
We can say that it generally involves;

Sender: The person who initiates the process of communication by sending a message;

Receiver: The one to whom the message is to be delivered

- **Eliminating Perceptual Differences**
- **Using Simple Language**
- **Reducing Noise**
- **Active Listening**
- **Managing Emotional States**
- **Maintaining a Simple Organizational Structure**
- **Avoiding Information Overload**
- **Providing Constructive Feedback**

- **Selecting the Appropriate Medium**
- **Maintaining Flexibility in Meeting Targets**
- **Maintaining Consistency of Messages**
- **Using Appropriate Body Language**
- **Keeping the Communication Chain Short**
- **Controlling Anger and Aggression**
- **Maintaining Clarity of Thought**
- **Understanding the Audience's Needs**



Completeness

- quantum of information needed for making a message complete
 - when it has all the necessary information which is required for the receiver of the message to act in a particular way. Considering that receivers differ in their mental filters as they are influenced by their backgrounds, viewpoints, needs, attitudes, status, and emotions, so the message should be complete in itself to minimize the possibility of different understanding of the same message by the different receivers.
-
- First, if the message is complete then the probability of the desired response of the sender becomes very high without incurring extra cost on additional messages.
 - Second, complete messages are helpful in developing and maintaining the goodwill of the organization.
 - Third, since the message is complete and no information is extra or omitted, the chances of legal actions against the organization are minimized.

Examples:

- i. When factory supervisor gives instructions regarding production of goods to the workers, he must specify the exact size, shape, quality and cost of the product. If there are any underlying assumptions to those instructions then they must also be clearly stated.
- ii. While answering a letter, all the questions raised in the letter must be replied.

Following points should be kept in mind, for completeness of message:

- 1. Include all the essentials.
- 2. Answer all questions asked.
- 3. Give something extra, when desirable.
- 4. Check for the five W's:
 - i. (i) Who (ii) What (iii) Where (iv) When & (v) Why

Conciseness

- Conciseness means the ability of conveying what you have to say in the minimum possible words with maximum possible meaning conveyed, that is, without sacrificing the other C qualities of the message. Conciseness is desired because a concise message saves time and expense for both sender and receiver.
 - Quantum of information should be just right, neither too much neither too little.
1. **Brevity and relevance**
 2. **Avoid jargons**
 3. **Use audience relevant words**
 4. **Avoid unnecessary repetition**
 5. **Eliminate wordy expressions**
 6. **Include only relevant statements, material**

All that is being said here is that *time management* skill is important for a successful career.

Consideration means that you should prepare every message by keeping recipient in mind and by putting yourself in his or her place. Before drafting the message think about their psychological and circumstantial situations, their limitations, aspirations and likely reactions to the message and accordingly design the message.

1. Empathize with the receiver:

Use concepts and language with which the receiver can relate. Show respect to the sentiments, ideas, notion, concept and values of the receiver.

2. Bond with the audience:

Focus on 'you' or 'we' instead of 'I'.

Example: Head of the Sales team instead of saying –

“ In the last quarter my team has performed very well but in coming months you all have to generate even higher targets so you have to get ready.

He should say-

“ In the last quarter all of us as a team have performed very well but in coming months we have to generate even higher targets so all of us should get ready”

Concreteness

Communicating with concreteness means being specific, definite and vivid rather than vague and general regarding the issue under discussion.

Ask yourself a few questions:

- 🎬 Is the message to the point?
- 🎬 Have you been specific in presentation of issues?
- 🎬 What is the goal, the objective of your communication?

Abstract Words: The student received a high grade in the test.

Concrete Words: Neha received an 'A' in the Business Statistics exam.

Clarity

Clarity means designing and getting your message across in such a manner that the receiver understands your message as you intended him to understand. So for receiver to understand the message clearly the sender must design the message keeping in mind the background and understanding level of the receiver.

Example:

For common understanding instead of writing that 'the website is now fully operational with the ecommerce functionality setup', one should write 'the company has launched its website'.

1. Use easily understandable language as per the ability of the receivers of the message.
2. Finish one theme before starting with another in a write up or conversation.
3. Include examples, illustrations, and other visual aids, when desirable.

Courtesy

Communication is an activity of mutual give and take of ideas and information. And in business communication, almost everything starts with and ends in courtesy. If you want the receiver to be polite and to listen, you must be willing to extend the same courtesy to the receiver. Courteous messages help to strengthen present employee as well as business relations, as well as make new relations.

- i. While it is easy to say “Shut the door” as it use few words and less energy , the impact of “Can you please shut the door?” is much greater.
- ii. A young executive sending a document to his superior may end the mail with the sentence, “Please feel free to revert to me in case of any problems or queries.”

Instead write,

“Please inform if any clarification is required or any modification is needed to be done.”

Correctness

Correctness is understood in terms of the appropriate choice of words and tone for communicating the message as well as the correctness of the information.

The term correctness, as applied to a business message, means the writer should:

- i. Use correct grammar and appropriate language
- ii. Include only accurate facts, and figures
- iii. Maintain acceptable writing mechanics
- iv. Choose non-discriminatory expressions
- v. Apply all other pertinent C qualities

Examples:

- i. A truck hit him hardly, leading to a fractured hand.

‘Hardly’ refers to something scarcely done. A truck hardly hitting someone should not be cause for worry!

When force is implied, the correct sentence will be –

A truck hit him hard, leading to a fractured hand.